Developing Web Applications with CGI::Application

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Introduction

- Ask Questions Freely
- I don't have all the answers

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CGI

- Started off simple
- Stateless Limitation
- Complex application code can become unwieldy **VERY** quickly

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HTML::Template

- My adoption path started off with HTML::Template

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CGI::Application Solution

- Object-oriented Design
- Split Web application code into three parts:
  - Instance Script
  - Centralized/Modularized Code
  - Presentation Templates
- Very useful for multiple-screen applications
- Lends itself to powerful future enhancements

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Separation of design and code!

- Very important
- Two sides of the brain
- Protects against collusion

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HelloWorld Redux

- Let's look at CGI HelloWorld
- Now let's look at CGI::App HelloWorld
- And let's look at CGI::App + HTML::Template HelloWorld

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Sample Project

- Let's learn by example
- Account Manager Application

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Step Overview

1. Mock-up Screens
2. Write Instance Script
3. Write CGI::App Frame PM
4. Code / Test / Debug
5. Roll Out

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First Step

- Mock-up the screens
- Translate them into simple HTML template files

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Second Step

- Write the debug version of the instance script

```
#!C:\Perl\bin\perl.exe -wT

$|++;
use CGI::Carp qw( fatalsToBrowser );
use lib './';
use strict;
open( STDERR, ">&STDOUT" );
print "Content-type: text/html\n\n";

use HelloWorld;

my $hello = HelloWorld->new();
$hello->run();
```

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Third Step

- Create the CGI::App shell

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Fourth Step

- Flesh out the code

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Now let's take these to 11...

- DBI to authenticate? Other user data?
- Runmode methods can pass control to other methods
- CGI::Cookie to maintain user identity?
- CGI::Application::ValidateRM
- mod_perl to speed things up?

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Code Reuse

- Other CGI::App .pm files can refer to each other's subroutines to reuse common code

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Questions?

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Stuff to Take Away

- Give this a shot soon!
- Practice Makes Perfect

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